SHARING RIVER WATERS

Two rivers, the Ganga and Teesta, of the 54 transboundary waterways the two countries share, have been a sticking point for years. A 1983 water-sharing agreement on the Teesta never took off. Last month, when Chinese envoy Yao Wen visited Rangpur, near the sensitive Siliguri Corridor, to assess the proposed $1 billion Teesta River Comprehensive Management and Restoration Project, India was rattled. Meanwhile, the water-sharing agreement on the Ganga is up for renewal in Dec. 2026 (after 30 years), but expect hard talk and recriminations on the Farakka barrage's excesses.



The Teesta at Sevoke, West Bengal

AFP

PROXIMITY TO PAKISTAN

New Delhi is uneasy about the thawing of relations between Pakistan and Bangladesh since Sheikh Hasina's ouster in 2024. High-level meets, including between Pakistan prime minister **Shehbaz Sharif** and Bangladesh interim president **Muhammad Yunus**, have been taking place, even through India's intense tensions with Pakistan in May. Another pain point is the electoral resurgence of Islamist group Jamaat-e-Islami in Bangladesh, particularly in districts close to West Bengal. The party stood with Pakistan during the 1971 war, but is now the largest opposition party in the government. India will expect the new government to contain extremist mobilisation through financial scrutiny and keep the party away from security policy.



ANI

THE CHINA FACTOR

India is watching how Dhaka manages Chinese-funded infrastructure and water projects, especially those close to sensitive regions like the **Siliguri Corridor**. Transparent diplomacy can prevent conflicts and allow Bangladesh to pursue its partnerships. Another concern is Bangladesh's growing reliance on China for defence, particularly for submarines and managing critical ports.





PERSECUTION OF HINDUS AND MINORITIES

India has persistently objected to the lack of safety and political representation for Hindus and other minorities in Bangladesh under the Yunus government. A recent flare-up was the murder of **Dipu Chandra Das**, a garment worker in Mymensingh. Under Rahman, there is hope that things can change, signalled by his repeated emphasis on inclusion, and by the appointment of Nitai Roy Chowdhury, a respected senior leader, as minister of cultural affairs.